

ZHENGXIONG LI

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Ph.D., Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering

Madison, USA

09/2024 – Present

Wuhan University

B.S., Microelectronics Science and Engineering, Hongyi Honor College

Wuhan, China

09/2020 – 06/2024

PUBLICATIONS

- Li, Z., Huang, T., Ogras, U. (2026). *SET: Stream-Event-Triggered Scheduling for Efficient CUDA Graph Pipelines*. International European Conference on Parallel and Distributed Processing (Euro-Par), Pisa, Italy. [\[Preprint\]](#)
- Jie, T., Li, Z., Ogras, U., Huang, T. (2025). *A Scalable Code Generation Flow for Heterogeneous Parallel RTL Simulation using MLIR*. IEEE High Performance Extreme Computing Conference (HPEC), Virtual. [\[DOI\]](#)
- Li, X.[†], Li, Z.[†], et al. (2024). *MSGM: An Advanced Deep Multi-Size Guiding Matching Network for Whole Slide Histopathology Images Addressing Staining Variation and Low Visibility Challenges*. IEEE Journal of Biomedical and Health Informatics (JBHI). [\[DOI\]](#) [†]Equal contribution.
- Li, X.[†], Hu, T.[†], Li, Z.[†], et al. (2024). *MRRM: Advanced Biomarker Alignment in Multi-Staining Pathology Images via Multi-Scale Ring Rotation-Invariant Matching*. IEEE Journal of Biomedical and Health Informatics (JBHI). [\[DOI\]](#) [†]Equal contribution.
- Hu, M., Jiang, X., Li, Z.. (2023). *A Resource-efficient FIR Filter Design Based on an RAG Improved Algorithm*. International Conference on Circuits and Systems (ICCS). [\[DOI\]](#)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

SET: Stream-Event-Triggered Scheduling for Efficient CUDA Graph Pipelines

Madison, USA

Research Assistant; Supervisor: Prof. Tsung-Wei Huang and Prof. Umit Ogras

06/2025 – 11/2025

- Developed a high-performance runtime framework (SET) for CUDA graphs to optimize GPU workloads scheduling; decomposed monolithic processing graphs into asynchronous, multi-stage pipelines to achieve overlap of memory transfers and computation.
- Designed a dynamic work-stealing scheduler to handle load balancing across multiple CUDA streams; utilized event-driven synchronization and non-blocking CUDA callbacks to decouple host scheduling overhead from device execution.
- Implemented a memory-safe, just-in-time parameter update mechanism for persistent CUDA graph executables, enabling the dynamic reuse of graph handles for different data payloads without the cost of re-instantiation.
- Conducted extensive performance analysis using NVIDIA Nsight Systems and Nsight Compute to identify synchronization bottlenecks; optimized pipeline depth and resource allocation, achieving up to 44% higher throughput and reducing scheduling overheads by up to 54% compared to baselines.

PROWESS: Processor Reconfiguration for Wideband Spectrum Sensing

Madison, USA

Research Assistant; Supervisor: Prof. Umit Ogras

09/2024 – 03/2025

- Implementing a system-level domain-specific SoC simulation framework (DS3) on Zynq platform. Porting the core on-chip scheduler module from Python to C to meet resource restrictions on embedded systems. Finding the optimal resource configuration that can guide the hardware team's design.
- Studied the communication overheads between on-chip scheduler (PS side) and program launcher (PL side) through AXI protocols. Found the optimal job distribution for task scheduling to achieve best efficiency and performance.
- Optimized the DS3 simulator to enable massive parallelization, including decoupling improper program design and refactoring stale data structures. Achieved up to 5x speedup.
- Performed design space exploration based on DS3 simulator and analyzed the generated data. Studied the impact on throughput caused by different factors, including processing elements (PEs) mesh architecture, iMEM size, communication overheads, etc. Identified the bottleneck to achieving higher throughput gains.

Development of an FPGA-Based Automatic Calibration System for RFIC

Wuhan, China

Undergraduate Researcher; Supervisor: Prof. Xianyang Jiang

05/2022 – 04/2023

- Designed a pair of SPI protocol communication interfaces to enable data transmission among the PC, FPGA board, and target chip to be calibrated.

- Employed the DDS method to develop a system generating periodically vibrating waveforms with high stability.
- Developed a series of FIR filters and verified their efficacy using Matlab while integrating various decimation modules to filter the digital data acquired from ADC for precise signal processing.
- Conducted simulation and debugging procedures for FPGA and PCB boards, leading to their successful deployment.

FPGA/GPU-Based Numerical Solvers for Sustainable Energy System Simulation

Edmonton, Canada

Research Intern; Mitacs Internship; Supervisor: Prof. Venkata Dinavahi

06/2023 – 09/2023

- Developed a high-performance solution for real-time simulation of electrical systems, ensuring the hardware's ability to predict the next 1us' situation within a strict time frame, such as 100ns or shorter.
- Trained GRU and LSTM models for Synchronous Machine and Induction Machine modeling.
- Implemented the pre-trained model on Xilinx Data Center Acceleration Card (U250), aiming to achieve real-time or faster than real-time simulation for the entire electrical system.

Multi-Scale Spatial Registration Method for Whole-Slide Pathology Images

Wuhan, China

Undergraduate Researcher; Supervisor: Prof. Cheng Lei

03/2023 – 05/2024

- Reviewed existing literature on pathology image analysis and identified limitations in current methods such as SIFT, KAZE, AKAZE, and BRISK.
- Developed an algorithm based on multi-scale spatial space for efficient extraction of image features; overcame challenges posed by rotation, missing parts, and color differences in whole-slide pathology image analysis.
- Successfully achieved image registration based on the extracted features and achieved a high level of accuracy.

COURSEWORK PROJECTS

GPU Benchmarks Porting and Simulation for AMD GPUs on gem5

Madison, USA

Project Leader

09/2024 – 12/2024

- Ported the Polybench and Lonestar benchmark suites from CUDA to AMD HIP, manually resolving inline assembly and library mismatches to enable cross-platform compatibility.
- Simulated AMD Vega 20 microarchitecture using the gem5 simulator to analyze performance characteristics, validating simulation accuracy against real-world Radeon VII hardware execution.
- Investigated the impact of dynamic vs. static register allocation schemes on irregular graph algorithms (BFS, SSSP), identifying resource contention bottlenecks and potential logic errors within the simulator's scheduling model.

FPGA-Based Ultra-High-Speed Panoramic Camera Image Stitching Project

Wuhan, China

Core Member

04/2023 – 06/2023

- Improved the performance of existing software algorithm and transformed it into hardware description language.
- Implemented the improved algorithm on a Xilinx FPGA development board, to achieve high resolution and high frame rate for panoramic camera image stitching.
- Collaborated with a diverse team, including fellow students from the laboratory, engineers from the company, and students from Huazhong University of Science and Technology.

HONORS & AWARDS

63rd Design Automation Conference (DAC) Young Fellow	07/2026
UW-Madison David and Sarah Epstein Fellowship	06/2026
62nd Design Automation Conference (DAC) Young Fellow	07/2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Teaching Assistant of Digital Logic Circuit Laboratory Experiment Course

04/2023 – 06/2023

- Conducted seminars, collected technical documents, graded them, and contributed to curriculum design.
- Successfully recruited exceptional students to the laboratory through targeted outreach efforts.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Programming: CUDA, C & C++, Python, LLVM, MLIR, Verilog, Matlab

Laboratory Techniques: Nsight Systems Profiler, GDB, Vitis, Vivado, Quartus, Modelsim, FPGA hardware debug, FPGA software development

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent)